

ment was taxed as a luxury item. Getting Apollo built in Chennai took years of meetings with bureaucrats, and Dr Reddy eventually secured the backing of the government at the highest level, including a meeting with Prime Minister Indira Gandhi. Apollo opened in 1983.

Since then, the group has grown into more than 70 hospitals, nearly 6,000 pharmacies, and a network of clinics, diagnostic centres and a medical college. The group crossed ₹25,000 crore in consolidated revenue for the first time in the year ended March 2026, up 16% from the year before, with Apollo HealthCo, its pharmacy and digital arm, turning profitable for the first time. Dr Reddy has also spent much of the last four decades campaigning for policy change, pushing for mandatory health insurance and preventive check-ups.

On the philosophy that has carried him through, he is fond of repeating a line he once heard, that “medical expenditure is not an expenditure; it is an investment in your health”. That, along with the Padma Vibhushan he was awarded for his contribution to healthcare, sums up the way he talks about his own legacy.

Dr. Devi Shetty, Founder and Chairman of Narayana Health, came at the problem from a different angle. A cardiac surgeon who had worked in England, he returned to

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**“I never wanted to build just another hospital. I wanted to build an institution that patients could trust and healthcare professionals would be proud to be part of”**

**DR. AASHISH CHAUDHRY**

MANAGING DIRECTOR, AAKASH HEALTHCARE



**DR. AZAD MOOPEN**

FOUNDER CHAIRMAN,  
ASTER DM HEALTHCARE

**(FY26 REVENUE: ₹4,643 CR)**

**Dr. Azad Moopen began his entrepreneurial journey with a single clinic in Dubai in 1987, after moving there from Kerala, where he had trained as a physician. Over the following decades, he grew that modest practice into Aster DM Healthcare, spanning hospitals, clinics and pharmacies across the Gulf region and India. Guided by the principle that healthcare should remain accessible across income groups, he built a delivery model that combines primary, secondary and tertiary care under one umbrella, allowing patients to move seamlessly across levels of treatment.**